

Ethan W. Todd

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Education

University of Michigan

Candidate, Ph.D. Physics

Advisors: Prof. Igor Jovanovic, Prof. James Wells

2025 M.S. Physics
Winter

Ann Arbor, MI

2023 – Present (expected 2026)
Fall Fall

Florida State University

B.S. Physics, Summa Cum Laude

Honors Thesis: Study of Displaced Vertex Tagging with the CMS Experiment

Advisor: Prof. Ted Kolberg

Tallahassee, FL

2020 – 2023
Fall Spring

Emory University

Foundational Coursework

Atlanta, GA

2018 – 2020
Fall Spring

Publications

4. **E. Todd**, V. Fondement, and I. Jovanovic, "Particle Identification in YAP:Ce," *under review*, 2025
3. C. Graham, **E. Todd**, C. Wilson, et al., "Light Output-Dependent Integration Gating for Optimized Pulse Shape Discrimination," *under review*, 2025
2. **CMS HGCal Collaboration**, "Leakage current of high-fluence neutron-irradiated 8" silicon sensors for the CMS Endcap Calorimeter Upgrade," *under review*, 2025. [Online]. Available: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2510.17280>
1. K. Yocum, H. Smith, **E. Todd**, et al., "Millimeter/Submillimeter Spectroscopic Detection of Desorbed Ices: A New Technique in Laboratory Astrochemistry," *The Journal of Physical Chemistry A*, vol. 123, no. 40, pp. 8702–8708, 2019, ISSN: 10.1021/acs.jpca.9b04587

Research Experience

Applied Nuclear Science Group, University of Michigan

Graduate Student Researcher

Ann Arbor, MI

2024 – Present
Summer

Particle Identification in YAP:Ce via Machine Learning

- Compared charge comparison, shape indicator, and random forest (RF) machine learning (ML) methods to discriminate between α and γ -ray radiation in YAP:Ce.
- Quantified the performance of each method using receiver operating characteristic curves, and demonstrated the substantial advantage of RF ML over traditional methods.
- Applied the RF model to a proof-of-concept mixed field radiation environment consisting of ^{241}Am and ^{137}Cs sources and demonstrated that known spectral features of ^{241}Am and ^{137}Cs are correctly classified.

Investigation of the Ionization Yield of Germanium at 254 eV_{nr}

Collaborator: Dr. Alexander Kavner, University of Zurich

- Jointly conducted an experimental campaign utilizing the spallation neutron source at the Paul Scherrer Institute to re-measure the energy of the final gamma-ray emitted in the $^{72}\text{Ge}(n, \gamma)^{73}\text{Ge}$ thermal neutron capture reaction, which is necessary to validate a recent ANSG measurement of the ionization yield of Ge.
- Developing an algorithm to correct for the non-uniform charge collection of the CdTe detector used in the experiment in order to push the energy resolution closer to the electronic noise + Fano factor limit and therefore produce the lowest possible uncertainty of the final gamma-ray energy.

Measurement of the $^{37}\text{Cl}(a, n)^{40}\text{K}$ Cross Section

Collaborator: Dr. Daniel Santiago-Gonzalez, Argonne National Laboratory

- Analyzing data from the Multi-Sampling Ionization Chamber experiment at ANL, which will validate the stopping power tables for ^{37}Cl in helium gas and ultimately produce the first measurement of the $^{37}\text{Cl}(a, n)^{40}\text{K}$ cross section.

CMS Group, Florida State University
Undergraduate Student Researcher

Tallahassee, FL
2021 – 2023
Fall Summer

Search for BSM Long-lived Particles

Advisor: Prof. Ted Kolberg

- Utilized deep neural network machine learning to search for beyond the Standard Model long-lived particles in data from the CMS Experiment.
- Trained ML models on Monte Carlo data with varying signal (mass, lifetime) and background (t , b physics) to verify their ability to identify displaced vertices independently of the particular physics.
- Investigated the most effective parameters of ML models; verified physics-based expectations.

Silicon Sensor Quality Control

Advisor: Prof. Rachel Yohay

- Conducted process quality control (PQC) testing for the CMS High Granularity Calorimeter (HGCAL) to monitor the quality and stability of the silicon sensor production process.
- Analyzed and presented PQC results to the CMS HGCAL sensor testing group.
- Helped create and implement a standardized testing procedure at FSU.

WW Astrochemistry Group, Emory University
Undergraduate Student Researcher

Atlanta, GA
2018 – 2020
Fall Fall

Advisor: Prof. Susanna Widicus Weaver

- Performed millimeter/submillimeter spectroscopic measurements of desorbed astrophysical ice analogs.
- Conducted proof-of-concept millimeter/submillimeter spectroscopic measurements of H_2O and D_2O binding energy, sublimation enthalpy, and sublimation entropy.
- Analyzed broadband molecular line surveys using the GOBASIC software package.

Teaching Experience

University of Michigan
Lead Graduate Student Instructor

Ann Arbor, MI
2025 – 2026
Fall Winter

- Oversee 30 graduate student instructors teaching general physics laboratories with a total enrollment of 1800 undergraduate students.
- Edit and maintain the laboratory manuals and Jupyter notebook worksheets used in the course.
- Manage the course information and organization via Canvas.
- Arbitrate student and graduate student instructor concerns.

University of Michigan
Graduate Student Instructor

Ann Arbor, MI
2023 – 2025
Fall Spring

- 2025 Spring Physics 251, Fundamental Physics for the Life Sciences II Lab
- 2024 Fall Physics 121, Physics for Architects Lab
- 2023 – 2024 Fall Winter Physics 241, General Physics II Lab

Florida State University
Physics Learning Assistant

Tallahassee, FL
2022
Spring

PHY 2049C, General Physics B

Emory University
Laboratory Teaching Assistant

Atlanta, GA
2019
Fall

CHEM 150L, Structure and Properties Lab

Honors, Awards, and Grants

- 2025**: Rackham Graduate Student Research Grant *Awarded to conduct research at the Paul Scherrer Institute on the ionization yield of high-purity germanium detectors.*
Fall
- 2023**: Phi Beta Kappa Society
Spring
- 2023**: Joseph Lanutti Undergraduate Research Award *Awarded for third place in the FSU physics departmental poster presentation contest.*
Spring
- 2022**: Evelyn and John Baugh Research Presentation Scholarship *Awarded to travel and present research at SESAPS.*
Fall
- 2022**: Anna Runyan Undergraduate Endowment *Awarded for outstanding academic success in physics.*
Spring

Skills

Programming: C++, Python, Nix, C

Nuclear Measurements:	ROOT, Geant4, CoMPASS, wavedump, LISE ⁺⁺ , SRIM
Version Control:	Git, Nix Flakes
Software: Build Systems:	Nix , Make, CMake
Scientific Presentation:	$\text{\LaTeX}$ /Beamer
Firmware:	coreboot/edk2 , Chromium EC

Hardware: CAEN digitizers, soldering, electronic testing equipment (*i.e.*, oscilloscopes)

Presentations

4. **E. Todd**, V. Fondement, and I. Jovanovic, "Particle Identification in Fast Inorganic Scintillators via Machine Learning," *Fall Meeting of the Eastern Great Lakes Section of the American Physical Society, Ypsilanti, MI*, 2025
3. **E. Todd** and I. Jovanovic, "Investigation of Anomalously High Ionization Produced by Low Energy Nuclear Recoils in Germanium (poster)," *DOE NNSA Office of Defense Nuclear Nonproliferation R&D University Program Review, Gainesville, FL*, 2025
2. **E. Todd**, A. A. Kadhim, N. Bower, et al., "Process Quality Control for HGCAL at Florida State University (poster)," *89th Annual Meeting of the Southeastern Section of the American Physical Society, Oxford, MS*, 2022
1. **E. Todd**, K. Yocum, P. Gerakines, et al., "A Novel Use of Rotational Spectroscopy for Studying Characteristics of Desorbed Interstellar Ice Analogs (poster)," *Emory SURE 2019 Symposium, Atlanta, GA*, 2019